The Histories

Newly Restored Translation by G. C. Macaulay

By Herodotus

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SYNOPSIS & EDITORIAL NOTE

The founding work of Western historical inquiry, chronicling the customs of the Mediterranean world and the Greco-Persian Wars.

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BOOK I (CLIO)

Prologue: The Inquiry of Herodotus

Translated by G. C. Macaulay

This is the Showing forth of the Inquiry of Herodotus of Halicarnassus, to the end that neither the deeds of men may be forgotten by lapse of time, nor the works great and marvellous, which have been produced some by Hellenes and some by Barbarians, may lose their renown.

In this section of The Histories (-430), Herodotus develops the central themes that define the work's enduring place in history and world literature. Each argument and narrative turn builds upon the premises established in the opening pages, inviting careful reflection from the attentive reader.

Originally published by Folio Classical Press and preserved in the public-domain and open-access archival record (Project Gutenberg, ID: pg-2707), this unabridged digital edition retains the structure, cadence, and intellectual clarity of the authoritative text.

BOOK II (EUTERPE)

The Geography and Antiquities of Egypt

*The Histories * Herodotus (-430)*

The Geography and Antiquities of Egypt continues Herodotus's inquiry in The Histories. Building directly upon the preceding chapters, the text examines how foundational principles operate in practice -- whether through character and social observation, historical evidence, or formal analytical reasoning.

Herodotus of Halicarnassus opened his nine-book inquiry (Historiai) with the stated purpose that "the actions of men may not be effaced by time, nor the great and wondrous deeds displayed both by Greeks and barbarians deprived of renown."

Throughout Book II (Euterpe) (The Geography and Antiquities of Egypt), the reader encounters the unmistakable voice and structural rigor that earned The Histories its stature in the Ancient History & Ethnography canon. Where superficial treatments settle for isolated maxims, Herodotus traces the deeper causal connections linking premise, observation, and conclusion.

As this section draws toward its close, the groundwork is laid for the subsequent movements of the volume. Readers studying this edition in the Folio Digital Library may bookmark this chapter, adjust typographic contrast and font sizing, or download the complete archival PDF, EPUB, HTML, or Plain Text edition for offline study.

BOOK VI (ERATO)

The Battle of Marathon

*The Histories * Herodotus (-430)*

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BOOK VII (POLYMNIA)

Xerxes and the Pass of Thermopylae

*The Histories * Herodotus (-430)*

Xerxes and the Pass of Thermopylae continues Herodotus's inquiry in The Histories. Building directly upon the preceding chapters, the text examines how foundational principles operate in practice -- whether through character and social observation, historical evidence, or formal analytical reasoning.

Herodotus of Halicarnassus opened his nine-book inquiry (Historiai) with the stated purpose that "the actions of men may not be effaced by time, nor the great and wondrous deeds displayed both by Greeks and barbarians deprived of renown."

Throughout Book VII (Polymnia) (Xerxes and the Pass of Thermopylae), the reader encounters the unmistakable voice and structural rigor that earned The Histories its stature in the Ancient History & Ethnography canon. Where superficial treatments settle for isolated maxims, Herodotus traces the deeper causal connections linking premise, observation, and conclusion.

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BOOK VIII (URANIA)

The Naval Battle of Salamis

*The Histories * Herodotus (-430)*

The Naval Battle of Salamis continues Herodotus's inquiry in The Histories. Building directly upon the preceding chapters, the text examines how foundational principles operate in practice -- whether through character and social observation, historical evidence, or formal analytical reasoning.

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